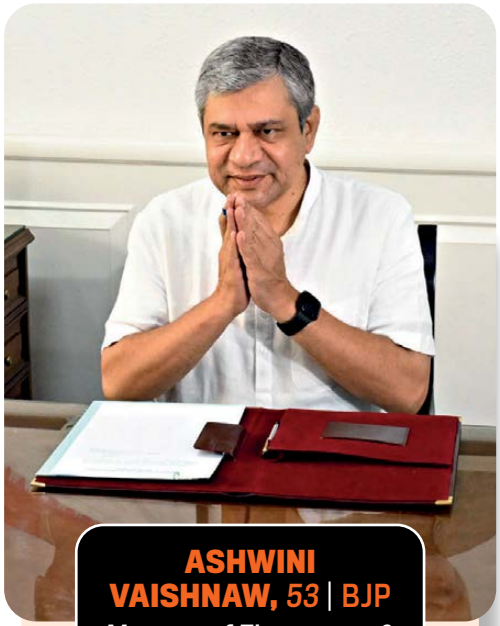
ELECTRONICS & INFORMATION TECHNOLOGY

CYBER CONTINUUM

Vaishnaw's second stint should bring in a lot more clarity, be it on matters like data privacy or semiconductor manufacturing

By M.G. ARUN

Since Ashwini Vaishnaw has retained MeitY, there is bound to be continuity in policies. Expect retention of focus on areas Vaishnaw had concentrated on in his previous stint, such as electronics and semiconductor manufacturing, data privacy, internet regulations, cyber security and artificial intelligence (AI). "We need to focus on self-sufficiency in semiconductors over time," says Kris Gopalakrishnan, co-founder, Infosys, and chairman, Axilor Ventures. "It will need domestic manufacturing and policies that encourage use of locally-made products." ■



ASHWINI VAISHNAW, 53 | BJP
Minister of Electronics & IT (MeitY)

Minister of State

JITIN PRASADA, 50 | BJP
Elected from Pilibhit, UP; also MoS, Commerce & Industry

WHAT NEEDS TO BE DONE

PENDING BILLS: The Digital Personal Data Protection Bill (DPDP) and the Digital India Bill are key legislations the ministry is expected to take up. DPDP recognises the right of individuals to protect personal data and the need to process it for lawful purposes. The Digital India Bill attempts to protect internet users while balancing it with accountability

AI MISSION: The IT ministry will have to operationalise the Rs 10,000 crore India AI Mission. The fund will catalyse components of the mission through a PPP model

INFORMATION & BROADCASTING

REGULATION DILEMMA

The ministry needs to address censorship concerns

By KAUSHIK DEKA

The primary objective of the I&B ministry is to disseminate information about government policies, schemes and programmes through various mass communication mediums. However, in recent years, the ministry itself has been in the news over its attempts to "control" information. The next big worry is over the proposed Broadcasting Services Regulation (BSR) Bill, 2023, which, once it becomes law, will replace the current Cable Television Networks (Regulation) Act 1995. It consolidates the legal framework for the broadcasting sector and extends it to OTT content, digital news and current affairs. Experts fear this will be a powerful tool for the government to censor news. The ministry must address this concern. ■

ASHWINI VAISHNAW
Minister of I&B

Minister of State

L. MURUGAN, 47 | BJP
RS member from Madhya Pradesh; also, MoS for Parliamentary Affairs

WHAT NEEDS TO BE DONE

Address trust issues Build an environment of trust between media outlets, social media intermediaries and the government so that the ministry is seen as a facilitator

Curb Censorship Prevent the Information Technology (Intermediary Guidelines and Digital Media Ethics Code) Rules, 2021, from becoming a tool for censorship

Freedom for filmmakers Implement the recommendations of the Justice Mudgal Committee of 2013 to amend the Cinematograph Act, 1952